

CLA Brand & Design Language OS v1

Master Working Draft

This document is cumulative. Every approved section is retained. Future updates append new approved sections without removing previous ones.

Section 1 — Brand Personality (APPROVED)

Elegant • Minimal • Vibrant.

Elegant through craftsmanship and restraint. Minimal through clarity and intentional spacing.

Vibrant through carefully chosen color, photography, and moments of energy—not clutter.

Section 2 — Visual Direction (APPROVED)

Apple-level product quality combined with a modern premium church aesthetic. Premium craftsmanship, timeless design, welcoming, professional execution, and every page should point people back to Jesus through clarity rather than distraction.

Section 3 — Official Color System (APPROVED)

Primary: Royal Blue.

Dark Foundation: Dark Navy.

Backgrounds: White + Warm Off-White/Ivory.

Gold: Secondary accent used sparingly.

Orange: Supporting accent used globally and more prominently for Kids, Events, and Seasonal pages.

Gradients may be used when elegant and purposeful.

Each ministry may have its own accent color while remaining unmistakably CLA.

Section 4 — Typography (APPROVED)

Apple-inspired modern + elegant editorial typography.

Two font families by default; third only for special campaigns.

Bold, commanding headings.

Neutral, highly readable body text.

Very strong hierarchy.

Mixed alignment.

Apple-style rounded buttons.

Generous white space.

Moderate motion.

Mostly solid typography colors.

Section 5 — Photography (APPROVED)

Authentic real moments; never staged or stock-like.

Tone matches the story.

Balanced immersive and contained layouts.

Balanced portraits and environmental storytelling.

Preserve natural orientation; never force portrait into landscape crops or vice versa.

Balanced natural/cinematic editing.

One strong image per section by default.

Minimal decorative effects.

Editorial overlap only when it improves composition.

Consistent CLA photography style.

Every major page begins with a signature hero photograph.

Section 6 — Layout & White Space (APPROVED)

Balanced layout.
Medium content width.
Balanced spacing.
Large Apple-inspired rounded corners.
Balanced mix of symmetrical and asymmetrical layouts.
Cards are a core CLA component.
Whitespace separates sections.
Signature sections may intentionally break the grid.
Forms use premium cards.
Desktop primarily two-column.
Mobile single-column by default with selective two-column use.
Whitespace is a design element.

Section 7 — Cards (APPROVED)

Premium, elegant, minimal cards.
Mixed backgrounds with white as default.
Subtle shadows.
Thin subtle borders.
One consistent corner radius.
Glassmorphism only for special premium moments.
One clear purpose per card.
Premium micro-interactions.
Images depend on card type.
One primary CTA per card.
Equal heights in grids whenever practical.
Use elegant non-emoji icons only.

Next Section

Section 8 — Radius & Shadows (Not yet completed)